



KEEPING IT REAL

ONE QUESTION DEFUSES THE PRICE TALK.

It's the first thing Bill Melnick asks when he inherits an overpriced listing.

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Keeping It Real Podcast

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**"WHO SET THE
PRICE? DID YOU, OR
ANY AGENT, BASED
ON COMPS?"**

Bill Melnick, luxury agent, Litchfield County,
Connecticut. Over \$144 million in career volume.

HE SOLD A TENNIS LEGEND'S ESTATE FOR 12 MILLION AFTER ANOTHER AGENT LISTED IT AT 20.

The Ivan Lendl estate first hit the market in 2014 at just under \$20 million with a different agent. It didn't move. Bill Melnick took it over, brought in drone photography it had never had, and partnered with other local and New York agents to find the buyer himself. It sold in 2024 for \$12 million, still the county record. The hard part was never the marketing. It was getting the seller to accept that the number from the first listing was wrong. His opener: "who set the price, you or an agent, based on comps?" Once the seller answers, he hands the verdict to the listing history itself: "the market is speaking. It's not me. The market is telling you it's not worth the current price."

HOW TO TAKE OVER A LISTING THAT DIDN'T SELL:

1 Ask who set the price.

"Did you, or did an agent, based on comps?" Most sellers say "an agent." Follow with "based on what?"

2 Let the market talk, not you.

Point to how long it sat. That is the market's verdict, not your opinion of the seller's home.

3 Bring comps if you have them.

On a one-of-a-kind property with none, say so. It's an emotional conversation at that point, not a data one, and pretending otherwise doesn't help.

4 Build a team before you need one.

Call the agents who've sold near that price point. A \$12 million house does not sell off one agent's own buyer list.



THE TAKEAWAY

**YOU'RE NOT THE
ONE SAYING THE
PRICE IS WRONG.
THE MARKET
ALREADY DID.**

Your job is just to hand them the message.